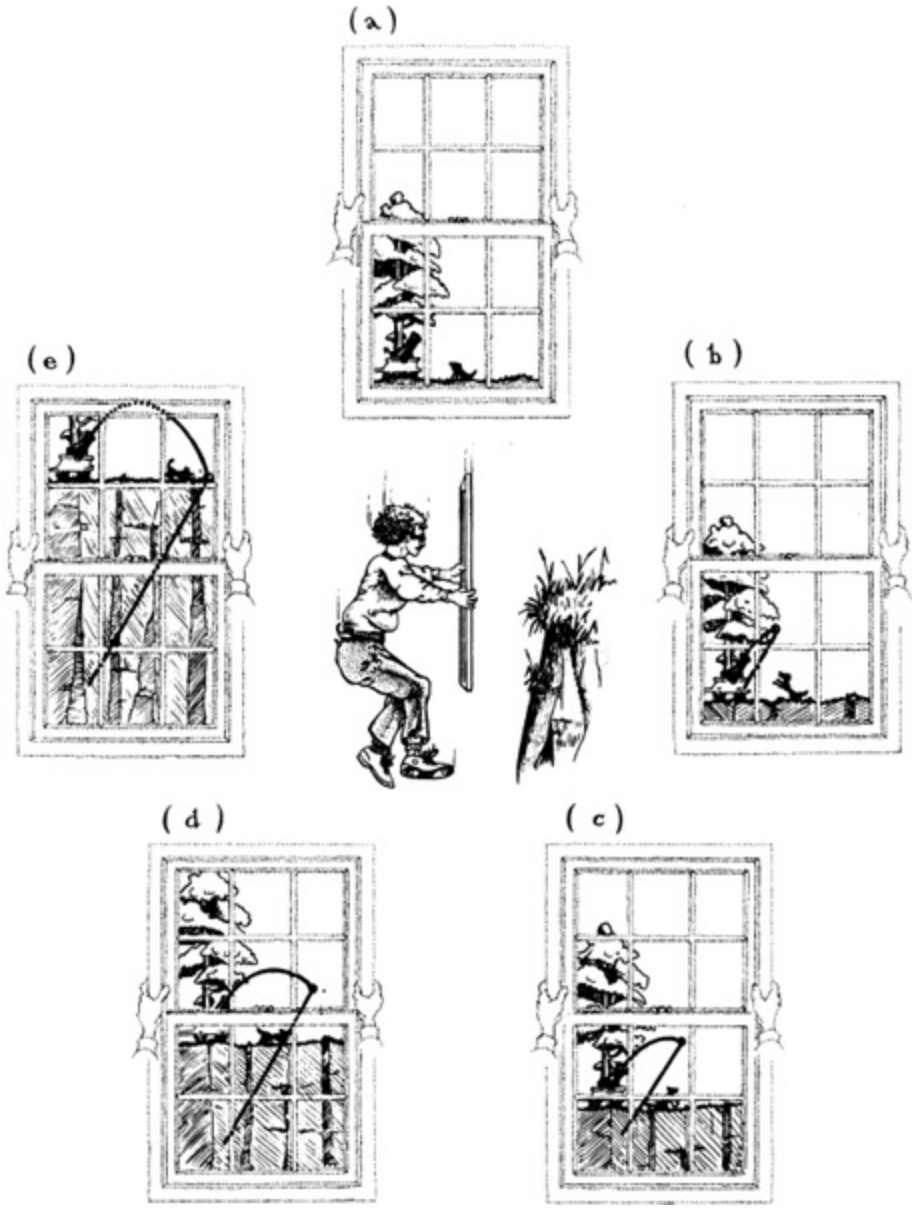


2.2 Center: You jump off a cliff holding a twelve-paned window in front of yourself. Remainder of figure, clockwise from the top: What you see through the window when a cannon is fired. Relative to the falling window frame, the ball's trajectory is the straight, dashed line; relative to the dog and the Earth's surface, it is the solid parabola.

With this extension of his principle of relativity to include gravity, Einstein took his first step toward a new set of gravitational laws—his first step from *special* relativity to *general* relativity.

Be patient, dear reader. This chapter is probably the most difficult one in the book. My story will get less technical in the next chapter, when we start